the Washington landscape. The briefing was attended by about sixty experts in intelligence analysis, to whom we presented our doctrine, led by Shlomo.

The following is an excerpt from an unpublished paper written by Shlomo:

> I stood there and lectured passionately on the danger posed to the world by the Iraqi nuclear weapons that would appear in Saddam Hussein's arsenal in a matter of only one or two years. . . . I shot off all of the data with a sense of security that did not beg any questions about their truth. . . . I could not shake off the thoughts about "where I had come from." From the beginning of my journey as a twelve-year-old boy, I set myself the goal of teaching myself every day, from a dictionary, fifty new words in English. This child's achievements came to a peak in this place, during this presentation.

The results of the Washington visit were real and immediate. The Americans agreed to continue, even more intensively, the exchange of information and assessments regarding Iraq's nonconventional capabilities, including the nuclear issue. The next step was the visit by an American delegation to Israel for further discussions and the establishment of joint action.

The defense minister continued his visit in the United States. Shlomo and I flew from Washington to London for a meeting with the head of MI6 and the personal assistant of British prime minister Margaret Thatcher. The meeting, in which we repeated the entire libretto, took place on August 2, 1990. While we were sitting with the two gentlemen, the assistant to the head of MI6 entered the room, whispered something in his ear, and left. The MI6 head turned to us and said, "Saddam Hussein invaded Kuwait!"

Shlomo continued from London to Munich in order to brief the head of the BND (the German intelligence service, equivalent to the Mossad) and its experts. I returned to Israel.

On the last weekend before the outbreak of the war, a secret meeting took place between Prime Minister Shamir and King Hussein on the latter's estate outside London. In addition to the prime minister, the Israeli delegation included IDF deputy chief of staff Ehud Barak, deputy head of the Mossad Efraim Halevy, Cabinet Secretary Elyakim Rubinstein, and director general of the Prime Minister's Office Yossi Ben-Aharon. In order to keep the meeting secret not only from the British but also from the Israelis, it took place on the weekend so that the absence of the prime minister was not felt. The delegation stayed at the king's estate for two nights. Because the delegation had a majority of those who observed the Sabbath and the rules of *kashrut,*the king's men made sure to provide new